

HYUN SOO SUH

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EDUCATION

- Washington University in St. Louis** 2021 –
◦ Ph.D. in Economics 2027 (Expected)
◦ M.A. in Economics 2023
- Boston University** 2019 – 2020
◦ M.A. in Economics *MA Prize of Academic Excellence*
- Korea University** 2015 – 2019
◦ B.A. in Economics & B.A. in French Language and Literature *Great Honor*
- Sciences Po** Fall 2017
◦ Exchange Student in Economics *Le Certificat en Sciences Sociales et Humanités*

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

- **Who Gains from Maternal Employment? Self-Employment, Childcare, and Child Development**
Abstract: Whether a mother's employment helps or harms her child depends on how well formal childcare substitutes for the time she withdraws. Using a household life-cycle model of work arrangements, time, and child skill formation on UK panel data, I estimate that this substitutability differs sharply by education. I use the paid-versus-self-employment margin to decompose a work arrangement into three prices: flexibility, an earnings level, and earnings volatility, to isolate the value of flexibility for children from pay. A college-educated mother's time is her child's most productive input, so formal care substitutes poorly for it, while for a non-college mother it substitutes well. Fathers do not respond, so the burden falls on the mother. The same full-time entry therefore lowers a child's skills by 0.22 and 0.15 SD when the mother is college-educated but raises them by 0.12 and 0.16 SD when she is not. Work-family policies such as flexible hours and subsidized childcare reach children differently. Flexible hours raise maternal employment by up to four percentage points but leave child skills essentially unchanged. Childcare raises skills only when tagged by education. Pairing the two makes both groups better off and raises non-college children's projected lifetime earnings by up to six percent.

Publications

- **Beyond Time and Money: Parental Occupation and Early Childhood Development**
AEA Papers and Proceedings, 116: 605–610.

Working Papers

- **Female Micro-Entrepreneurship and Child Development** (with Andrew Foster and Moritz Poll)
◦ **Mental Health and the Early Career Dynamics of Young Men** (with Cecilia Diaz-Campo, Barton Hamilton, and Martin Luccioni)

Work in Progress

- **Sorting on Gains: The STEM Gender Gap in Jamaica** (with George-Levi Gayle, Peter-John Gordon, Nadine McCloud-Rose, Rana Mohie Eldin, and Ismaël Mourifié)
◦ **Are Schools Equalizers or Amplifiers? School Value Added After a Randomized Anti-Poverty Program** (with Moritz Poll)

AWARDS & GRANTS

- **Weiss Fund Research Grant** \$24,953; with Moritz Poll 2026 – 2028
◦ **J-PAL Learning for All Initiative Grant** \$74,800; with Moritz Poll 2025 – 2026

◦ J-PAL Gender and Economic Agency Initiative Grant	\$49,696; with Moritz Poll	2025 – 2026
◦ INED Visiting Ph.D. Fellowship		Summer 2023
◦ Washington University in St. Louis Fellowship		2021 – Present
◦ Boston University Merit-Based Scholarship		2019 – 2020
◦ Boston University RA-Mentor Program Scholarship		Spring 2020
◦ Boston University Manuel Abdala Grant for Fieldwork		Spring 2020
◦ Boston University MA Prize of Academic Excellence		Spring 2020
◦ Korea University Great Honor		Fall 2019
◦ Korea University Semester High Honors		2015 – 2019

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

◦ Center for the Economics of Human Development	Visitor in residence	2026 – 2027
◦ Washington University in St. Louis	RA to George-Lévi Gayle	Fall 2022 – Present
◦ Washington University in St. Louis	RA to Cecilia Diaz-Campo	Fall 2023
◦ World Bank	Short-Term Consultant	Mar – Jun 2021
◦ University of Pennsylvania	RA to Hans-Peter Kohler & Iliana Kohler	Mar – Aug 2021
◦ Boston University	RA to Yoonsook Ha	Oct 2019 – Jul 2021
◦ Boston University	RA to Mahesh Karra	Oct 2019 – Jun 2020
◦ Boston University	RA to Jordi Jaumandreu	Oct 2019 – May 2020
◦ INED	Internship	Jan – Mar 2019

TEACHING

Washington University in St. Louis

◦ Instructor: Introduction to Microeconomics	[Syllabus]	Summer 2025
◦ Instructor: Introduction to Stata	[Syllabus]	Spring 2024
◦ Assistant Instructor: Health Analytics (Spring 2026), Structural Microeconometrics - Graduate (Spring 2025), Microeconomics (Summer 2024), Industrial Organization (Fall 2022), Introduction to Microeconomics (Fall 2022)		

Korea University

◦ Peer Tutor: Microeconomics		Fall 2018
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CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS († scheduled · ‡ by co-author)

- **2026** Allied Social Science Associations, West Indies Economic Conference, Midwest Economic Association[†], Centre for the Study of African Economies, North East Universities Gender Day, Population Association of America, Advances with Field Experiments[†], University of Pennsylvania[†]
- **2025** Midwest Economic Association, WashU Applied Micro, Southeastern Health Economics Study Group Conference, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference, Annual Health Econometrics Workshop[‡], WashU Olin Brown Bag
- **2024** WashU Applied Micro, WashU Graduate Research Symposium (3rd prize, Social Sciences), WashU Olin Brown Bag, American Society of Health Economists

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee Annals of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Development Economics, Agricultural and Resource Economics Review, Studies in Family Planning

Service Washington University in St. Louis

◦ President, Graduate Student Association	2024 – 2025
◦ Member, Graduate Student Association	2022 – 2026

- Co-organizer, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference (18th, 19th) 2023, 2024
- Co-organizer, WashU Job Market Jamboree (1st, 2nd) 2023, 2024
- Organizer, Applied Micro Research Group 2023 – 2024
- Co-organizer, Applied Metrics Study Group 2023 – 2024

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- Socio-Economic Inequalities in Multidimensional Early Child Development: Evidence from France (with Lidia Panico and Anne Solaz)
Population, Conditionally Accepted.
- Understanding Relations between State-Level Variation in TANF Spending and Substantiated Child Maltreatment in the USA (with Yoonsook Ha, Judith C. Scott, Mary Elizabeth Collins)
Journal of Social Service Research, 48.4, 2022: 441–450.
- Embedding Financial Services in Frequented, Trusted Settings: Building on Families' Pre-existing Economic Mobility Efforts (with Savannah P. Alexander, Inhye Cellina Kim, Cyndie Hatcher, Yoonsook Ha, and Lucy E. Marcil)
Journal of Developmental & Behavioral Pediatrics, 43.7, 2022: e442–451.
- Climate Change and Productivity of Northeastern Dairy Farms (with Rigoberto A. Lopez, Christopher Laughton, and Donghoon Kim)
Agricultural and Resource Economics Review, 51.2, 2022: 203–221.

SKILLS

Programming Matlab, Julia, Stata, $\LaTeX$, QGIS

Languages Korean (native), English, French (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor Barton H. Hamilton
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Professor George-Levi Gayle
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in St. Louis
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Professor Ismaël Y. Mourifié
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